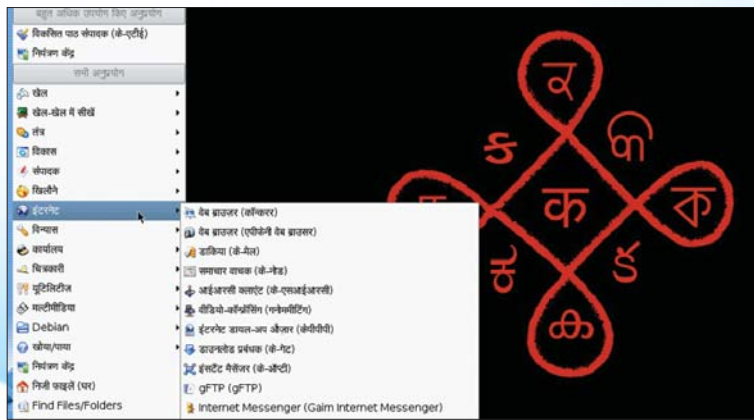




A Linux distribution with support for Indian languages—marking a step ahead

typing using a menu in the KDE taskbar, though you can't do so in GNOME.

This is no scaled-down operating system—a large number of programs are included. There's

everything from browsers and text editors to games and even videoconferencing tools. A couple of very important programs are missing, though—there's no Firefox, but you will find the Mozilla Web browser. The KDE documentation, for those who need it, has topic names in Hindi, but the text is all in English. Translating it all would be a mammoth task, we'd imagine.

People who are used to English versions of Linux as their Desktops might find using the regional languages a little confusing, but newcomers to computers and to Linux might find this a lot easier.

IndLinux sets out in the right direction—it's really good for people who want to use computers but don't have good command over the English language. It doesn't have support for all the regional languages in our country, but the IndLinux site links to teams developing and translating programs to other languages. Perhaps future releases will implement more languages.



Gaming

A lot of people hesitate from using Linux because of the lack of games, not to mention the trouble of hunting down the few games that do exist, and then set them up. A lot of distributions, however, do all the dirty work for you, so all you have to do is play!

live.linux-gamers.net 0.9.2

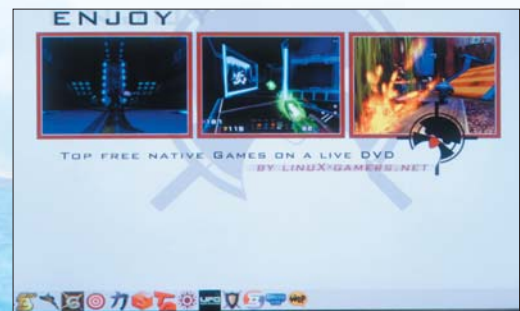
Site: <http://live.linux-gamers.net/>
Size: 2.36 GB

The Linux Live Game Project is a compilation of games for Linux, and requires no previous knowledge on how to set up Linux and all its applications. It's a Live DVD that's based on Arch Linux, so there is no need to create space and partition drives, either.

Depending on your hardware, you'd be well warned that some of your drivers may not be open source. We ran our tests on an NVIDIA-based motherboard. This can be a little irritating to see every time you boot up: you need to agree to continue, and once you do, the drivers are loaded and the GUI boots up. There's not much to see here other than a thick bar with a list of games there.

Now the games on this distribution aren't your typical low-end-card games you find on your Windows and Linux Desktops. These are full-fledged 3D games, including FPSes like *Warsow*, *Tremulous*, and *World of Padman*. *Sauerbraten* is another pretty good-looking game that makes use of some fancy-looking shaders.

It's not all FPS mayhem either—games like *Foobilliards*



A distribution for less-than-casual gamers

(a pool game) and *Blobby 2* (a 2D ball game) will appeal to casual gamers. Real-time Strategy (RTS) and Role-playing Game (RPG) fans can always try out *Warzone 2100* and *The Battle for Wesnoth*. For those with a need for speed there's *TORCS* (The Open Racing Car Simulator)—a fairly decent-looking car racing game, and *gl-117*—a rather bad-looking flight simulator.

The performance of the games on our test machine—an AMD64 3800+ with 1 GB of RAM and the onboard NVIDIA 6150 graphics—was more or less satisfactory. What is irritating is the amount of time games take to load off the DVD. You can save your settings on a USB drive if you wish.

Unfortunately, other than playing games, there's nothing much you can do with this distribution. If that's all you want, then Linux Live Game Project has a decent collection of games where you can spend a lot of free time. ☒

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3D games form most of the distribution